

11th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education

Survey response 1

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GENERAL INFORMATION

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I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education[1]

Is your country a State Party to the Convention?
Yes
Is the Convention directly applicable in your country 's domestic law ?
No
Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education [1]? [1] Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.
Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked ?

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence. Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with the respect to the right to education.

Norway is a State Party to the UNESCO 1960 Convention and Recommendations against Discrimination in Education. The Convention was ratified in 1963. UNESCO's 1960 convention on its own is not specifically incorporated into national legislation. The Convention has been made directly applicable by incorporation in Norwegian domestic legal instruments. By the Storting (Norwegian parliament) decision of 13 May 2014, the Constitution of Norway was supplemented with a number of human rights provisions. The principles of equality and non-discrimination were incorporated into Article 98 of the Constitution.

The Equality and Anti-discrimination Ombud is an independent body that promotes equality and prevents discrimination in all areas of society. The Ombud provides guidance on the anti-discrimination legislation and ensures that Norwegian legislation and administrative practice are consistent with the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women, the International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination and the Convention of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities. Complaints concerning breaches of the legislation are dealt with by the Anti-Discrimination Tribunal. The mandate of the Ombud is stipulated under the Norwegian Anti-Discrimination Ombud Act:

<https://lovdata.no/dokument/NLE/lov/2017-06-16-50>

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4). 1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

Yes

- If yes, please provide reference:

Major principles and values reflected in the 1960 Convention are similar to fundamental values in the Norwegian welfare state underpinning the integration and social inclusion policies. It is also in line with Norway's approach to Agenda 2030 and particularly Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG 4): Ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all.

As stated in the Reporting Guidelines: "Representing a powerful tool to advance SDG 4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work, the Convention has been recognized as a cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda."

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to "substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes". [Legal texts (Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.) prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education]

Yes

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to "substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes". [Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education]

Yes

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to "substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes". [Combating discrimination in terms of curriculum]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)]
Yes
Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In primary education]
Yes
Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In secondary education]
Yes
Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In technical and vocational education and training]
Yes
Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In higher education]
Yes
Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In adult education and alternative learning]
Yes

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

Act relating to equality and a prohibition against discrimination (Equality and Anti-Discrimination Act)

(Link: <https://lovdata.no/dokument/NLE/lov/2017-06-16-51>)

The purpose of this Act is to promote equality and prevent discrimination on the basis of gender, pregnancy, leave in connection with childbirth or adoption, care responsibilities, ethnicity, religion, belief, disability, sexual orientation, gender identity, gender expression, age or other significant characteristics of a person. This Act has the particular objective of improving the position of women and minorities. This Act shall help to dismantle disabling barriers created by society and prevent new ones from being created.

The Act applies to all sectors in Norwegian society, including education and training.

Act relating to kindergartens (the Kindergarten Act)

(Link: https://lovdata.no/dokument/NLE/lov/2005-06-17-64/KAPITTEL_5#KAPITTEL_5)

The Purpose clause in the Kindergarten Act states that "The kindergarten shall promote democracy and equality and counteract all forms of discrimination" (Section 1). Kindergartens shall "help to ensure social equality" and must strive to promote "gender equality in their educational practice. In their daily operation the institutions shall take account of children's age, level of functioning, gender, and social, ethnic, and cultural background, including the language and culture of Sami children (Section 2 – 4).

Section 16 gives all children of one year of age right to a place in a kindergarten. Children who reach the age of one by the end of August in the year of the application for a place in a kindergarten, are entitled to a place from that August. Children who reach the age of one in September, October, or November in the year of the application, are entitled to a place by the end of the month they reach the age of one. Participation in a kindergarten is voluntary, but 93.4 per cent of children aged 1–5 and 97.4 per cent of all 5-year-olds attended in 2022.

Act relating to Primary and Secondary Education (the Education Act)

(Link (only available in Norwegian): <https://lovdata.no/dokument/NL/lov/2023-06-09-30?q=oppl%C3%A6ringslova>)

The Purpose Clause in section 1-3 states that the education and training, amongst other purposes, shall "provide insight into cultural diversity and show respect for the individual's convictions. [...]", and that "All forms of discrimination shall be combated."

According to section 2-1, children and young people are obliged to attend primary and lower secondary education, and have the right to a public primary and lower secondary education. Every person that has completed ten years of compulsory education is entitled by law to three years of upper secondary education and training according to section 5-1. Primary and Secondary Education is supplied free of charge.

The school has according to section 11-1 a duty to ensure that the education and training is adapted to the pupil's abilities and aptitudes. Section 11-4 –11-6 gives pupils who needs this the right to necessary physical adaptation and technical aids, personal assistance and individually tailored training.

Act relating to universities and university colleges

(Link (only available in Norwegian): <https://lovdata.no/dokument/NL/lov/2024-03-08-9>)

The Act relating to universities and university colleges guarantees equal access to higher education. Student admission is regulated in chapter 8 of this Act, in order to ensure a fair admission process. Section 2-5 guarantees that higher education at state institutions is free of charge, with certain exceptions. Student from outside the European Economic Area and Switzerland need to pay tuition fees in Norway according to section 2-6, with exceptions.

According to section 10-1 of the Act, higher education institutions (HEI) are obliged to ensure that the students' learning environment is satisfactory on the basis of an overall assessment of considerations regarding the health, safety and welfare of the students. The institution must have a learning environment committee to assist in ensuring implementation. The committee must take part in the planning of measures relating to the learning environment and closely follow developments in matters concerning the safety and learning environment of the students.

As mentioned above, the prohibition of non-discrimination is regulated in the Equality and Anti-Discrimination Act.

Certain aspects are, however, regulated more in detail specifically for higher education. The most important approach to ensure inclusion is the requirement for universal design of the HEI's as regulated in the Act section 10-2. This includes the HEI's main functions, such as physical environment, and information and communication technology, including the digital learning environment. Exception for this obligation relates to disproportional burden for the institutions, regulated by the Equality and Anti-Discrimination Act, sections 17 and 18.

In addition, the Act relating to universities and university colleges contains a specific obligation in section 10-3 for the institutions' board to work to prevent and stop harassment and sexual harassment, cf. section 13 of the Equality and Anti-Discrimination Act. Students with a disability and students with special needs are entitled to suitable individual adaptation of the learning environment, teaching, teaching materials and examinations, in order to ensure equal training and education opportunities, according to the Act relating to universities and university colleges, section 10-5. According to the Act relating to universities and university colleges, section 10-7, students are also ensured a right to parental leave and to resume their study program at the appropriate stage after the leave .

Act relating to student financial aid (the Student Financial Aid Act)

(Link: <https://lovdata.no/dokument/NLE/lov/2005-06-03-37>)

The Norwegian Government's aim is equal access to higher education. The act relating to universities and university colleges is to ensure that students have equal rights for admission to higher education, and that universities and university colleges facilitate this happening. Higher education students are entitled to get grants and/or loans from The State Educational Loan Fund.

The State Educational Loan Fund allocates grants and loans to pupils and students according to an official cost of living estimate, stipulated annually. The support is meant to cover expenses for accommodation, subsistence costs and study materials. Means testing of the parents' economy was disbanded in the early 1970s.

Students with special needs can apply for additional support. There are special arrangements for maternity leave, illness and students with children. The size of the grant also depends on the income of the student and the income of spouse or cohabitant. Loans are interest free during the studies. In cases of low income, unemployment, illness, childbirth or care of small children, repayments may be postponed for a period and the interest can be waived. All, or parts of the loan, may also be cancelled if illness prevents the person from working.

Act on student welfare organizations

(Link (only available in Norwegian): <https://lovdata.no/dokument/NL/lov/2007-12-14-116>)

A student welfare organization shall, in cooperation with education institutions, offer students welfare, such as student housing.

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)]

Yes

Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In primary education]

Yes

Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In secondary education]

Yes

Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In technical and vocational education and training]

Yes

Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In higher education]

Yes

Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In adult education and alternative learning]

Yes

- Please provide details:

Please see information provided in other parts of the reporting, for relevant information regarding measures concerning discrimination and equal access. Below is information on relevant strategies, action plans and white papers that also include the education sector.

The Government's strategy for the equality of persons with disabilities 2020-2030 "A Society For All" has education as one of four focus areas: <https://www.regjeringen.no/en/dokumenter/a-society-for-all/id2623105/>

The Government's action plan for the equality of persons with disabilities (2020-2025) equally has education as one of four focus areas: <https://www.regjeringen.no/contentassets/4538c7392f3d417a8d7cc48965a603c9/et-samfunn-for-alle---regjeringens-handlingsplan-for-likestilling-av-personer-med-funksjonsnedsettelse-des-2019.pdf> (in Norwegian only)

The Government's action plan for universal design (2021-2025) also has a special focus on education: <https://www.regjeringen.no/no/dokumenter/barekraft-og-like-muligheter-et-universelt-utformet-norge/id2867676/> (in Norwegian only)

The right to education is discussed in white paper no. 8 (2022-2023) Human rights for persons with intellectual disabilities: <https://www.regjeringen.no/contentassets/3ea1c0ef367a44ee8d3597a04f86c8f7/nn-no/pdfs/stm202220230008000dddpdfs.pdf> (in Norwegian only)

The Government's action plan on Gender and Sexual Diversity (2023-2026) has several measures for the education sector: <https://www.regjeringen.no/en/dokumenter/the-norwegian-governments-action-plan-on-gender-and-sexual-diversity-20232026/id2963172/>

The Government's action plan against racism and discrimination (2024-2027) has young people as one of its main target areas and contains several measures for the education sector: https://www.regjeringen.no/contentassets/8da2b05800224771a3548ba4007817e4/a-0061-e-action-plan-racism-and-discrimination_032024.pdf

The Government's action plan to combat discrimination and hatred towards muslims (2020-2023) contained several measures aimed at the education sector: <https://www.regjeringen.no/en/dokumenter/action-plan-to-combat-discrimination-and-hatred-towards-muslims-2020-2023/id2765543/>

An action plan against antisemitism was developed for the period of 2021-2023: <https://www.regjeringen.no/contentassets/9c3f6754f04844da971a26331b732b3f/action-plan-against-antisemitism-20212023-a-continuatio.pdf>

The action plan was a continuation of the action plan for the period 2016-2020, and it includes several measures within education. The Government announced in November 2023 that it will develop a new action plan against antisemitism, which will be presented in 2024.

Link to press release: <https://www.regjeringen.no/en/aktuelt/norway-steps-up-efforts-to-combat-anti-semitism/id3012774/>

Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)]

Yes

Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In primary education]

Yes

Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In secondary education]

Yes

Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In technical and vocational education and training]

Yes

Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In higher education]

Yes

Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In adult education and alternative learning]

Yes

- Please provide details:

Norway has recently introduced a major curriculum reform for primary and upper secondary education and training. The new core curriculum was introduced in 2017 and the subject curriculum, the Knowledge Promotion 2020, was implemented from the school year 2020/21.

The aim is to facilitate better learning for all, but also to better integrate generic competencies such as critical thinking and democratic citizenship. Education is about learning and about changes and preparing for the future. A whole-school approach shall promote learning and promote common values that are the foundation of our society. These are pivotal to respond to the major challenges we are facing in Norway, but also internationally. Therefore, the new curriculum emphasizes both the importance of certain values as well as deep learning and the ability to develop key competencies in different subjects in a balanced way.

The new core curriculum, Core curriculum – values and principles for primary and upper secondary education and training, was published in September 2017, and is a part of the framework for the renewal of the school subjects. Key elements in the core curriculum are e.g. human rights, democratic citizenship, inclusion and cultural awareness. Three new cross-curricular topics will be integrated in the subjects: Sustainable development, democracy and citizenship, and health and life skills. These topics are interdisciplinary-related and will be reflected in all subjects and in all grades where appropriate.

Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

White paper on grades 5-10 (Meld. St. 24 (2023-2024))

The Government presented a white paper to the Parliament that covers grades 5-10, in the Autumn of 2024. The aim of the White Paper is to explore and describe how the school to a greater extent can promote the pupils' motivation, mastery, learning and development. Among other things, the white paper looks at how the school can become more practical and varied. Link (only available in Norwegian): Meld. St. 24 (2023-2024) (regjeringen.no)

White paper on social equality and mobility

Equal opportunities for all children and young people are one of the Government's most important priorities. The government will strengthen the work to reduce economic and social differences, and this requires broad cooperation. That is why the Government has started work on a white paper to the Parliament that will be presented in the Spring of 2025. Education will be central to this work. Link to press release on the white paper concerning social equality and mobility (only available in Norwegian):

<https://www.regjeringen.no/no/aktuelt/regjeringen-styrker-innsatsen-i-arbeidet-for-sosial-utjevning/id3016039/>

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Legislation provides for inclusive education for all]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Teachers are trained on inclusive education and to value diversity]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Multiple and flexible learning pathways are provided for]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Multilingual and intercultural education is supported]

No

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Completion of education reform

The white paper on the completion of education reform (Fullføringsrefomen), (Meld. St. 21 (2020-2021)), was presented to the Parliament in 2021. The reform aims to regenerate upper secondary education, so that it equips students with better qualifications to meet future challenges, needs and opportunities. To strengthen pupils rights to upper secondary education, several changes has been adopted to the Education Act which entered into force on August 1st. 2024:

- ☐ provide all who start in upper secondary education the right to receive education until they achieve a vocational qualification or the Higher Education Entrance Qualification.

- ☐ to extend the right to an additional vocational qualification for those who have one vocational qualification or the Higher Education Entrance Qualification.

White Paper on Sami Language

In the spring of 2023, the Government presented a white paper on Sami language, culture and society – Competence and recruitment in kindergartens, schools and higher education. This will be followed up in cooperation with the Sami Parliament of Norway. In the new Education Act it is a statutory duty for municipal and county authorities to offer parts of the teaching in Sami in Sami-speaking environments if this is necessary for the training to be pedagogically sound. Furthermore, the right to training in Sami at the upper secondary school level has been extended to also apply to non-Sami students who have been taught in Sami or learned Sami in primary and lower secondary school. Link to summary in English:

<https://www.regjeringen.no/contentassets/de20a2a9ce434ff4a7cbf632ea759464/en-gb/pdfs/stm202320240012000engpdfs.pdf>

Grant Scheme

The Government has a grant scheme for specially adapted teaching materials and aids. Norway has introduced strict rules for the universal design of ICT, which also encompasses universal design of digital learning tools. Statped – the national special education service – produces and adapts learning materials for blind and weaksighted pupils and for deaf pupils/pupils who use sign languages.

White Paper on Professions Educations

The Government presented a white paper about the professions educations in 2024. The white paper presents measures for educating more teachers and for promoting equality and diversity in the educational programs. Following this white paper, the Government has also made changes to the rules of admission for teacher educations, to make the educations accessible to larger groups of applicants. The regulatory changes contribute to a concerted effort to improve teacher recruitment. To this end, there is also a national recruitment project and a recruitment strategy that was developed in close cooperation with employer organizations and professions organizations/unions. There is also an ongoing work with making the governance of teacher educations less detailed, so that the educational institutions attain greater freedom and flexibility in carrying out and developing their educational programs. Link (only available in Norwegian):

<https://www.regjeringen.no/contentassets/4ab6bbb12ed54f9f959364aec06ba3f6/nn-no/pdfs/stm202320240019000dddpdfs.pdf>

Decentralized and Flexible Education

Decentralized and flexible education is one of the Governments main priorities, to ensure that high quality education is made available for the whole population, independent of where you live or your background. The professions educations have been prioritized within this effort to strenghten decentralized and flexible education. The Directorate of higher education and skills (HK-dir) have managed a competition-based funding programme. In 2023, the Directorate announced a call for action for at total of 200 million Norwegian kroner (NOK) for flexible and decentralized education that the educational institutions and study centers could apply for. The education offers are spread across the whole country according to local, regional and national needs, and includes between other professional educations, and educations directed towards technology, digitization and the green transition. From 2024, the competition-based funds have been moved directly to the university colleges and universities as part of their main framework allocation, funded through the Ministry of Education and Research.

Chapter 8 (Section 41-43) of the Kindergarten Act concerns the psychosocial kindergarten environment. Section 41 states that kindergartens must not accept offensive acts such as exclusion, bullying, violence, discrimination and harassment. The kindergarten staff must intervene if a child in the kindergarten is exposed to such offensive acts. The kindergarten has a duty to actively make continuous and systematic efforts to promote the health, well-being, play and learning of the children. Section 42 gives the kindergarten staff a duty to take action to ensure that the children have a safe and beneficial psychosocial kindergarten environment.

Chapter 12 (Section 12-1–12-10) of the Education Act concerns the pupils' psychosocial school environment. Section 12-2 states that all pupils have the right to a safe and beneficial school environment that promotes health, inclusion, well-being and learning. According to section 12-3, the school must not accept offensive acts such as bullying, violence, discrimination and harassment. The school must work continuously to ensure that all pupils have a safe and beneficial school environment. The school staff must intervene if a pupil is exposed to such offensive acts, and section 12-4 gives the school staff a duty to take action to ensure that the pupils feel safe and content at school. If a pupil or the pupil's parents believe that the school is not doing enough to fulfil the pupil's right to a safe and beneficial school environment, they can report the matter to the county governor according to section 12-6.

The Act relating to universities and university colleges is to ensure that students have equal rights for admission to higher education, and that universities and university colleges facilitate this happening, see chapter 8 in this Act. A student at a university or a university college can get scholarships and/or loans from The State Educational Loan Fund. A student welfare organization shall, in cooperation with education institutions, offer students welfare, such as student housing.

As mentioned above, universities and university colleges are according to the Act relating to universities and university colleges, section 10-1, obliged to ensure that the students' learning environment at the institution is fully satisfactory on the basis of an overall assessment of considerations regarding the health, safety and welfare of the students. This includes both psychological and physical well-being.

In the Act on relating to universities and university colleges, it is provided that all education and training at the higher education institutions must be part of the institutions' quality assurance system, and that the quality assurance systems must be in line with the Standards and Guidelines for Quality Assurance in the European Higher Education Area. This includes requirements for student centred learning. The National Agency for Quality Assurance in Education, NOKUT, is responsible for periodic external review of the quality assurance systems.

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Consequences of COVID-19

- ☒ In the Spring of 2020, the Government implemented extensive measures to combat the spread of COVID-19. The measures had a major impact for all children and young people, with the closure of kindergartens, schools and recreational activities, and with reduced municipal services. The Government stated early on that priority would be given to children and young people, and that services for children and young people would be shielded as far as was possible and in compliance with the infection control guidelines.

- ☒ During the pandemic, the Government presented various packages with compensatory measures for children and young people, including measures to increase participation in holiday and recreational activities, measures to catch up on missed learning, and measures to strengthen mental health and prevent substance abuse problems.

- ☒ The Coronavirus Commission and the Coronavirus Special Committee both concluded that the infection control measures were particularly hard for children and young people. A report from the Norwegian Directorate for Education (2022) concludes that the pandemic had consequences for pupils' motivation, academic progress and learning.

- ☒ Between 2020 and 2022, the Government allocated a total of NOK 621 million for compensatory measures in the municipalities to mitigate the negative effects of the pandemic on learning and social development in children and young people.

A research group that has looked at the long-term consequences of the corona pandemic for pupils at lower secondary school has presented a report in 2024 (Subreport 2: The long-term consequences of the corona pandemic for pupils at lower secondary school, Vennerød-Diesen et al. NIFU, 2024) with the following main findings:

- ☒ Digital home school weakened the relationship between teacher and pupil.
- ☒ The pandemic intensified social exclusion.
- ☒ Pupils were given a lot of responsibility for their own learning during the pandemic.
- ☒ Vulnerable pupils have been more negatively affected by the pandemic than other pupils.

The pandemic reinforced already existing differences among pupils, and vulnerable pupils were particularly affected. Lower secondary school teachers express concern about the pupils' academic progress, especially in Norwegian and mathematics, and the fact that pupils experienced a loss of learning.

Temporary legislative measures during the pandemic

Temporary Act of 26 May 2020 No. 52 on adaptations in the Kindergarten Act, the Education Act and the Independent School Act to remedy the consequences of the outbreak of covid-19, provided temporary regulations in the area of kindergartens and schools during the pandemic. The purpose of the law was that children, youth and adults should have their rights safeguarded to the greatest extent possible under the Kindergartens Act, the Education Act and the Independent School Act, while taking into account what was possible when kindergartens and schools were closed or subject to restrictions of infection control reasons as a result of the outbreak of covid-19. Among other things, the Act provided the opportunity to make adjustments to the rules on the right to a place in kindergarten and facilitation during periods when the kindergartens were closed or operated with restrictions as a result of measures based on the Infection Control Act. As for schools, the Act established that school owners have a duty to provide education as far as possible, even if the schools are closed or operating with restrictions pursuant to individual decisions or regulations based on the Infection Control Act. Moreover, regulations were provided on the application of the Education Act and the Independent School Act during periods when schools were closed or operated with restrictions as a result of measures based on the Infection Control Act. The law was repealed on 31 December 2022.

Individual adoption

In Norway, the assessment of individual adoption needs takes place at the universities and university colleges, and the assessment must be in line with the provisions of the Act relating to universities and university colleges and the Equality and Anti-Discrimination Act. Individual adoption shall be assessed by the individual institution, and there are no national regulation stipulating what kind of individual adoption the institutions shall provide. Adequate knowledge and expertise at the institutions concerning individual adaptations is therefore important. As the responsibility lies with the institutions, different assessments and different practices may arise in individual cases. The Directorate for Higher Education and Skills (HK-dir) can provide guidance to the institutions on individual adaptation, universal design and learning environment. In addition to this, universities and university colleges shall ensure that all students have access to a Student Ombudsman (Studentombud), who can provide students with advice and assistance in matters related to their study situation, and contribute to safeguarding the students' legal rights. The Student Ombudsman cannot be instructed in his or her work, and can decide whether to assist a student in a given case. The Student Ombudsman does not have the authority to decide individual cases.

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Legislation provides for gender equality in education]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken]
No
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Providing positive or affirmative action measures]
No
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Providing financial incentives and fellowships]
No
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality]
Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]
Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education]
Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for]
Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities]
Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]
Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM)]
Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET)]
No
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Other]
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:
The Act relating to equality and a prohibition against discrimination (Equality and Anti-Discrimination Act) section 6 prohibits discrimination on the basis of gender, pregnancy, leave in connection with childbirth or adoption and care responsibilities. The Act applies to all sectors of society. See the answer provided in chapter 1.1. The government has a goal that higher education should be organized so that all students, even those who are in need of adjustment during the study, may be admitted to and implement education. Today there are a number of statutory instruments that could help the students get a study and examination situation that is tailored to the individual student's needs. A keyword here is cooperation between the student and the institution of good and appropriate solutions. This collaboration will ensure the academic requirements of the examination while the student receives a reasonable degree of facilitation. A plan of study could help to protect students' rights in this respect, since such a plan would raise awareness to institutions of their responsibility to facilitate the situation of those who have special needs. According to the act relating to universities and university colleges there shall also be a learning sample at the institution to contribute to students' learning environment is safeguarded. In all regulations on programmes of teacher education, there is a learning outcome on handling discrimination and promoting inclusion and special education needs. For further information concerning higher education in particular, see information provided in 1.1.
What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) [1]: Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married. [1] Please note that according to the Joint general recommendation No. 31 of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women/general comment No. 18 of the Committee on the Rights of the Child on harmful practice, para. 20: "a marriage of a mature, capable child below 18 years of age may be allowed in exceptional circumstances, provided that the child is at least 16 years of age and that such decisions are made by a judge based on legitimate exceptional grounds defined by law and on the evidence of maturity, without deference to culture and tradition."

Yes

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

According to the Marriage Act, Section 1 a. Age for marriage, no person under 18 years of age may enter into a marriage. Link: <https://lovdata.no/dokument/NLE/lov/1991-07-04-47>

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities]

No

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities]

No

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities]

No

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities]

No

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Teachers are trained on intercultural education]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Multilingual and intercultural education are supported]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]

No

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Pupils with a Kven-Finnish background who attend primary and lower secondary schools in the districts Troms and Finnmark, have the right to receive instruction in the Kven or Finnish language.

Please view information provided under part 1.1 for further relevant information concerning relevant legislation and national action plans.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Indigenous people: [Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people]

Yes

Indigenous people: [Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people]

Yes

Indigenous people: [Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities]

Yes

Indigenous people: [The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people]

No

Indigenous people: [Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people]

No

Indigenous people: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people]

No

Indigenous people: [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people]
No
Indigenous people: [Teachers are trained on intercultural education]
No
Indigenous people: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]
Yes
Indigenous people: [Multilingual and intercultural education are supported]
No
Indigenous people: [Native language instruction is ensured]
Yes
Indigenous people: [Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people]
No
Indigenous people: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]
Yes
Indigenous people: [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Pursuant to the Education Act section 3-2 and 6-2, Sami children in primary and secondary school have the right to receive Sami instruction. In addition, according to section 3-2 all children at the primary and lower secondary level in Sami districts have the right to receive their education both in Sami and through the medium of Sami. Outside Sami districts, if at least ten pupils in a municipality wish to receive instruction in and through the medium of Sami, they have the right to such education as long as there remain at least six pupils in the group.

Higher education in Sami is provided by Sámi University of Applied Sciences, UiT The Arctic University of Norway, Nord University. The two former mostly provide education and research in North Sami, and Nord University is responsible for Lule Sami and South Sami. These institutions have been given special responsibility for Sami research and higher education. These institutions must use, develop and strengthen Sami professional language. In the 2024 Act on higher education institutions section 10-2, Sami is a language of instruction on par with Norwegian. The institutions can make exceptions if it is professionally justified.

The Ministry of Local Government and Regional Development presented a bill to the Parliament in 2023, which applied new statutory provisions for the use of Sami languages. It entered into force in January 2024. The Ministry has consulted the Sámediggi (the Sami Parliament) about the bill and made changes based on their input. One main goal of the bill is to adapt the rules to the Sami language situation in different municipalities and to help ensure that more municipalities apply for incorporation into the administrative area for Sami languages.

In 2023, the Government presented a white paper on Sami language, culture, and social life, Sami language, culture, and social life — Competence and recruitment in kindergarten, basic education and higher education. The Government will follow up on the report in collaboration with the Sámediggi. The right to training in Sami at upper secondary level has been extended to also apply to non-Sami pupils who have had training in a Sami language or who had Sami in primary school. A summary of the white paper in English has been made available:

<https://www.regjeringen.no/contentassets/de20a2a9ce434ff4a7cbf632ea759464/en-gb/pdfs/stm202320240012000engpdfs.pdf>

Rules on consultations with Sami interests are codified in the Sami Act and came into force July 2021. They are largely a continuation of the Procedures for consultations and apply to central government authorities, counties, and municipalities, and to private legal entities when exercising authority on behalf of the State. The right to early consultations applies to the Sámediggi and other representatives of Sami interests in matters concerning legislation, regulations, and other decisions or measures that could directly affect Sami interests.

The Sami Pathfinders is a programme managed by the Sami University College and funded by the Central Government. Through this arrangement, four young Sami pupils (six from 2024–2025) receive a grant each year to visit upper secondary schools and organisations around the country to meet young people of their own age. The aim is to provide young people with information on Sami issues and what it is like to be a Sami person in Norway today. Experience shows that the pathfinder concept is a good way of addressing prejudices and misconceptions about the Sami and Sami cultures.

The Government announced in November 2023 that it has initiated a process on developing an action plan against slander and discrimination against the Sami people. The action plan is expected to be finalized in the fall of 2024. Link to press release (only in Norwegian): <https://www.regjeringen.no/no/aktuelt/regjeringen-trapper-opp-arbeidet-mot-samehets/id3014593/>

The Government's action plan against racism and discrimination (2024-2027) includes several measures targeting specially defined groups, including Sami: https://www.regjeringen.no/contentassets/8da2b05800224771a3548ba4007817e4/a-0061-e-action-plan-racism-and-discrimination_032024.pdf

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Recruitment

There is a challenge in recruiting pupils, students and teaching staff at all levels of Sami education.

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Legislation provides for their right to education]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for]
No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [All administrative barriers to access education are removed]
No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers are provided for]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Auxiliary assistance is provided]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Multiple and flexible learning pathways are provided]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Accelerated learning programmes are provided]
No

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided]

No

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Language classes to newcomers are provided for]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Statistics

In 2023, around 21 per cent of pupils in Norwegian primary schools had an immigrant background, and 41 per cent of these had immigrated themselves. 21.4 per cent of the students in upper secondary schools had an immigrant background, and 71 per cent of these had immigrated themselves. Immigrant students, especially those who arrive in Norway as teenagers, face tougher challenges than other students in achieving good results from their education.

Legislation provides for their right to education

Children from families seeking asylum do not have a right to a kindergarten place until their asylum application has been accepted and the family has a permanent address in a municipality. However, children staying in an asylum centre may enter a kindergarten if places are available in the municipality where the centre is located. A government grant finances full time places for all children in asylum centres aged one to five regardless of the status of their asylum application. For the municipalities to be better able to respond to the current refugee situation due to the war in Ukraine, some temporary legislative changes of the Kindergarten Act, making it easier to establish contemporary kindergartens, have been implemented. According to the Education Act section 2-1, the right to primary and lower secondary education applies when it is probable that the child will reside in Norway for a period of more than three months. The obligation to attend primary and lower secondary education commences as soon as the presence has lasted for three months. These rules apply to every child, including children of asylum seekers, unaccompanied minors seeking asylum and irregular immigrants. For the municipalities to be better able to respond to the current refugee situation due to the war in Ukraine, the Government suggested some temporary legislative changes, which the Storting approved. The temporary changes have been further extended. The most important temporary change of the Education Act has been that all children have the right to school as soon as possible and no later than within three months after arrival. Normally the rule is within one month. All children are obliged to go to school when they have been in the country for three months. The temporary legislation means that the municipalities have more time to prepare and provide fulltime education according to the Education Act. However, they have to offer the best possible education as soon as possible. Youth who have completed lower secondary school in Norway or a comparable education in another country, have the right to upper secondary education according to section 5-1 of the Education Act. This also applies to those who have completed further education in another country, but do not get the training approved as a study qualification or vocational qualification in Norway. The right only applies to those who are likely to be in Norway for more than three months. It is a condition for the right to upper secondary education that the applicant has legal residence in Norway. According to section 5-9 of the Education Act, persons who reside legally in the country while they are waiting for a response to their application for a residence permit have the right to upper secondary education for the school year leading up to the year they turn 18. Those whose application for a residence permit is rejected only have the right to further education until the date of the final decision. The application deadline for admission to upper secondary school is February 1 or March 1 each year, but the County Authority must also take into consideration applications they receive after the deadline. Some counties provided activities for youth from Ukraine shortly after they started arriving in Norway during spring 2022. All of them continue to provide education as applied for or other kinds of introductory offers. According to the Education Act section 9-7, students who have the right to upper secondary education can be given more primary/ lower secondary education before or in combination with upper secondary education. This will help students who need more preparatory education to benefit from upper secondary education. This is especially relevant for students arriving in Norway late in their schooling and have limited time before they enter upper secondary school. From 2020, the funds for the government scheme (The Job Opportunity Program Part B) to support school owners who organise such education were transferred to the county municipality. According to the Education Act section 3-6 and section 6-5, a pupil attending the primary, lower, and upper secondary education and who has a mother tongue other than Norwegian or Sami, has the right to adapted education in Norwegian until they are sufficiently proficient in Norwegian to attend the regular instruction offered. If necessary, such pupils are also entitled to mother tongue instruction, bilingual subject teaching, or both. In 2022-2023, almost 44 000 pupils in primary and lower secondary schools received adapted education in Norwegian.

Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education

For the municipalities and counties to be better able to respond to the current refugee situation due to the war in Ukraine, some temporary legislative changes are implemented (see legislation). Several measures have been initiated to assist the municipalities and counties in their work to provide good quality education for newly arrived children and youth from Ukraine. The Directorate of Education and Training has up dated all information relevant for education for newly arrived students. The directorate has also updated relevant guidance material, like a guide about introductory offers for newly arrived language minority students, and developed information about the Norwegian school system, for parents and students, in several languages, including Russian and Ukrainian. In Norway, we had several resources and digital tools to use in kindergartens and for teaching newly arrived students. We also had experience with digital multilingual resources and bilingual subject teaching, online. However, there were no teaching resources in Ukrainian. Therefore, digital resources like Bildetema (a dictionary with pictures), Lexin (a dictionary), Morsmål.no (webpage with multilingual resources for kindergartens and schools), skolekassa.no (website with learning tools in several languages) are being further developed by the National Center for Multicultural Education (NAFO).

Measures related to Ukrainian refugees in higher education

In order to adapt study programs and increase the capacity to host refugee students, the Government allocated additional funds in 2022, corresponding to 1000 study places from the Autumn of 2022. For these additional places, 540 students were registered. To make it easier for refugees to start/or continue higher education in Norway, the Ministry of Education and Research also adopted temporary changes in the criteria for admission to higher education. The changes applied for the academic year 2022-2023. The Government developed a scholarship scheme in 2022 for Ukrainian, Russian and Belarusian students who was

in Norway before the war started. The scheme applied to students who financed the study stay in Norway themselves, and who lost access to their financing because of the war. In 2023, the scheme was continued for Ukrainian students. Link to information about the measures: <https://www.regjeringen.no/en/aktuelt/government-changes-admission-rules-for-refugees-who-want-to-study/id2921641/>

Flexible education (bilingual subject teaching online) is also expanding. Flexible education offers bilingual teaching online (based upon Norwegian curricula) within English for beginners, mathematics, and science for the Arabic, Somali and Tigrinja languages. NAFO has developed bilingual subject teaching in Ukrainian, in the subjects' mathematics and basic Norwegian for language minorities. The school year 2023-2024 about 400 Ukrainian students benefited from this on-line teaching.

Extra funding has also been provided for the translation and development of pedagogical material for kindergarten and school (based upon the Norwegian curricula) in Ukrainian and Russian. This teaching material is now ready and available.

In spring 2023, the Government initiated measures to improve staffing and increase the competence in kindergartens and schools regarding newly arrived children and youth. According to the municipalities, the major challenges when it comes to providing newly arrived children and youth from Ukraine a satisfactory kindergarten and school service, is related to providing sufficient staff and staffing with the right competence. We have therefore developed an offer of continuing education at Oslo Metropolitan University, concerning the Norwegian kindergarten and school-system, for persons with a pedagogical education from abroad. In addition, the Norwegian Directorate for Education and Training has developed a free digital resource / course about the Norwegian kindergarten and school- system to be used for persons aiming for a job in kindergarten or school. The resource can also be used as a guidance material for employees in kindergartens and schools. It is important to mobilise Ukrainians with a relevant background in kindergartens and schools. NAFO has also developed web-based mini-courses and resources for teachers and schools teaching newly arrived students. In addition to targeted measures to improve the conditions for newly arrived children and youth, there are also other types of measures that can play an important role in the quality of their kindergarten and school offer; both general measures and measures targeting low-income families/areas. An example of the latter is the initiative in the national budgets for 2023 and 2024, to strengthen the teacher resources in schools and to improve school libraries in urban areas with major challenges in living conditions.

Inclusion into mainstream schools is ensured

Norwegian kindergartens shall be inclusive settings that provide children and families with the possibility to participate and be part of the community and fellowship. Many children do not have Norwegian as their mother tongue and learn Norwegian as a second language in kindergartens. Kindergartens must support them in their use of their mother tongue, whilst working actively to promote Norwegian language skills. The government aims to ensure that all children are proficient in Norwegian before starting school. This is fundamental in order to succeed in their continued learning and development, and to their active participation in society. Measures to increase participation of minority languages speaking children in kindergartens have therefore been put in place, such as reduced parental fees and free core time in kindergarten for low income-families and economic support to municipalities in developing reach-out measures. In addition to the latter, the Government made changes in 2020 in the process for applying for a place in kindergartens with the goal of making it easier for low- income families to document their income, thus ensuring these families reduced parental fees and free core hours. A pilot of universal free core time in kindergartens in municipalities, with a high proportion of migrants, showed good results for later schooling compared to areas without free core time. As indicated above, free core time has therefore been made available for children aged 2-5 from low-income families. Norwegian language development and instruction is a prerequisite for the full integration and inclusion of minority language children and pupils in Norway. In order to enhance integration and language development, the Government grants special economic support to the municipalities through the block grants transferred to municipalities for extra measures in kindergartens and provision of extra mothertongue and Norwegian language lessons to this group in schools. A special earmarked funding is provided to municipalities in order to support the kindergartens in minority children's Norwegian language development and is used in different ways; bilingual assistants, pedagogical material or Norwegian language activities. In 2023 this funding included 132 municipalities and 91% of all minority language children in kindergartens. As explained earlier, all children living in Norway have the right and the obligation to go to primary and lower secondary school. Most students go to the local, public school. A comprehensive school system that benefits all students is a central aim for the education policy. The objective is to provide good learning opportunities for all students, with special consideration of the needs of specific groups of children, such as those from language minorities or children who need special educational support. From August 2022, the Government introduced free part time participation in the plan for out-of-school hours care 12 hours per week for all first-grade pupils, and in August 2023 all second-grade pupils were included. From August 2024, the scheme will be extended to third-grade pupils. School enrolment among newly arrived children from Ukraine: Most of the children registered by the municipalities who have the right to a place in kindergarten, have received an offer of a place. In addition, some of the children not yet with the right to a place in kindergarten, have also been offered a place. By the 15th of December 2023, 2969 or about half of the ukrainian children arriving during the war in Ukraine attended kindergarten. As of October 1, 2023, it was reported in GSI that 8 216 displaced Ukrainian children of school-age were receiving a full-fledged education offer according to the Norwegian Education Act. Furthermore, the figures showed that there were 324 displaced Ukrainian children of school age, who have stayed in Norway for three months or more, who did not yet receive a full-fledged offer.

Teacher training

Kindergarten: The teacher education shall comply with the Kindergarten Act and the current regulations on the framework plan for the content and tasks of kindergartens. Schools: The teacher education shall be based on the Education Act and the current curricula for primary and secondary education. Multicultural competence and multilingualism are topics included in the national

regulations for teacher education. For several years, teaching Norwegian as a second language has been a part of the strategy for further education for teachers in school. Six teacher-training institutions provide relevant courses as part of the strategy. Childrens language development has been a topic for several years in the strategy for further education for teachers in kindergarten. Schools are important arenas for social and cultural inclusion. Teaching resources to counter group-focused enmity are developed for use in the various teacher education programs.

Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for

As explained above; there are financial mechanisms to make sure children from families with low income can afford to go to kindergarten. Primary, lower, and upper secondary schools are free of charge.

Language classes to newcomers are provided for

For pupils who have recently arrived in Norway, the local authority may organise their education in separate groups, classes, or schools. This applies to both primary, lower, and upper secondary schools. If some or all the education is to take place in such an introductory group, class, or school, this must be stipulated in the decision to provide adapted language education for the pupil. This decision may only be made if it is considered in the pupil's best interest. Education in a specially organised facility may last for up to two years. A decision may only be made for one year at a time. For this period, the teaching may deviate from the curriculum defined for the pupil in question to the extent it is required to provide for the needs of the pupil. Due to the temporary legislation, decisions pursuant to this section do not require the consent of the pupil or his/her parents or guardians.

Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged

Kindergartens shall use diversity as a resource in their pedagogical practices and support, empower and respond to the children according to their respective cultural and individual circumstances. Kindergartens shall highlight differences in values, religions, and world views. Kindergartens shall promote respect for human dignity by highlighting, valuing and promoting diversity and mutual respect. The children shall be able to discover that there are many ways in which to think, act and live. Staff shall help ensure that linguistic diversity becomes an enrichment for the entire group of children and encourage multilingual children to use their mother tongue while also actively promoting and developing the children's Norwegian/Sami language skills. Staff shall highlight linguistic and cultural diversity, support the children's different cultural expressions and identities and promote diversity in communication, language and other forms of expression. Framework Plan for Kindergartens (udir.no). The core curriculum for primary and secondary education implemented in 2020 states that "Schools shall give pupils historical and cultural insight that will give them a good foundation in their lives and help each pupil to preserve and develop her or his identity in an inclusive and diverse environment." (-) "All pupils shall experience that being proficient in a number of languages is a resource, both in school and society at large."

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Personell

The most comprehensive challenge the last few years has been lack of personnel with necessary competences within areas such as Norwegian as a second language, multicultural competences, lack of bilingual teachers and personnel with knowledge about children with trauma.

People with disabilities: [Legislation provides for their right to education]

Yes

People with disabilities: [Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education]

No

People with disabilities: [Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured]

Yes

People with disabilities: [Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools]

No

People with disabilities: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided]

No

People with disabilities: [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided]

No

People with disabilities: [Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities]

No

People with disabilities: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]
No
People with disabilities: [Auxiliary assistance is provided]
No
People with disabilities: [Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted]
No
People with disabilities: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]
No
People with disabilities: [Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted]
No
People with disabilities: [Other]
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:
Section 16 of the Kindergarten Act gives all children of one year of age right to a place in a kindergarten. See also chapter 1.1 above. Children who reach the age of one by the end of August in the year of the application for a place in a kindergarten, are entitled to a place from that August. Children who reach the age of one in September, October, or November in the year of the application, are entitled to a place by the end of the month they reach the age of one. According to Section 31 of the Kindergarten Act, children under compulsory school age are entitled to special educational assistance if they have special needs. This applies whether or not they attend a kindergarten. The objective of special educational assistance is to provide children with early help and support in development and learning, for example, language and social skills. According to the Education Act section 2-1, children and young people are obliged to attend primary and lower secondary education, and have the right to a public primary and lower secondary education. Every person that has completed ten years of compulsory education is entitled by law to three years of upper secondary education and training according to section 5-1. See also chapter 1.1 above. The school has according to section 11-1 a duty to ensure that the education and training is adapted to the pupil's abilities and aptitudes. Section 11-4 –11-6 gives pupils who needs this the right to necessary physical adaptation and technical aids, personal assistance and individually tailored training. Primary and lower secondary school pupils have the right to attend the school that is closest to where they live, or the school designated for the catchment area where they live. (Education Act section 2-6). The pupils may be divided into groups as necessary. The groups must not be larger than is need for social belonging. Pupils shall not normally be organised according to level of ability, gender or ethnic affiliation. (Education Act section 14-2). Higher education students with a disability and students with special needs are entitled to suitable individual adaptation of the learning environment, teaching, teaching materials and examinations, in order to ensure equal training and education opportunities, according to the Act relating to universities and university colleges, section 10-5. The institutions' responsibility to ensure a good learning environment, as mentioned above, also includes questions about individual adaptation of the examination. The institution shall, as far it is possible and reasonable, arrange for students with special needs. Facilitation must however not lead to a reduction of the academic requirements of each program according to the act relating to universities and university colleges section 10-5. In addition, all universities and university colleges shall ensure that the institutions' functions and facilities are universally designed, see section 10-2. This does not only apply to physical surroundings, but also to the institution's general functions and information and communication technology (ICT). Students with disabilities requiring special equipment such as wheelchairs, specifically designed cars, or costly assistance like interpreters for the deaf, are entitled to receive such equipment and services through the Norwegian Labour and Welfare Administration (NAV).
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.
Students from poor households: [Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided]
No
Students from poor households: [Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education]
No

Students from poor households: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided]
Yes
Students from poor households: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]
Yes
Students from poor households: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]
No
Students from poor households: [Other]
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:
Please see relevant text provided under parts 1.1 and 1.2.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free]
No
2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable]
Yes
2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis]
Yes

2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play.]

Yes

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

Early Childhood Education and Care (ECEC) is a non-obligatory part of the education system in Norway. ECEC is provided by kindergartens. These are pedagogical institutions that cater for children from 0 to 5 years of age. Some 50 % of the kindergartens are privately owned and operated with public funding, based on formal approval by the authorities. Since 2009 all children, irrespective of their background, have a legal right to a place in kindergarten from 1 year of age 2.

Nearly all children in Norway have been to Kindergarten before entering primary school. The participation rate for all three, four- and five-year olds is 97.2 %. A high proportion of children less than 3 years of age also have a place in a kindergarten (88.6 %). For minority language speaking children, the participation rate is a little lower than for the age cohort as a whole. This also holds true for the three, four- and five-year olds, but the gap is more evident for younger minority children. 94.7 % of minority languages speaking 5-year olds now attend kindergarten before entering school. However, participation rates for minority languages speaking children have increased also for the youngest children. Participation of minority language speaking children aged 1-2 years has risen from 69.1 % in 2019 to 75 % in 2023.

Parental fees are regulated with a maximum fee that is set in the State budget annually. Since 2020 the maximum parental fees has been reduced from NOK 3150/month to NOK 2000/month (36 % reduction). In addition there are arrangements to reduce price or make it free for siblings and for reduced price/free admission for children in low-income families and in certain geographical areas. All children have the right to a place in ECEC from age 1. Please see box below.

New regulation: In 2020 a new chapter in the Kindergarten Act was introduced to ensure a good psychosocial kindergarten environment that strengthens the protection of children in kindergarten from exclusion, bullying, violence, discrimination and harassment (Kindergarten Act Chapter VIII, entered into force January 2021). The kindergarten shall prevent situations where children do not have a safe and good kindergarten environment by continuously working to promote the health, well-being, play and learning of the children. The regulation stipulates a duty for everyone working in kindergarten to ensure and to act so that all children in kindergarten have a safe and good psychosocial kindergarten environment. There is an enhanced duty to act if someone working in the kindergarten violates a child right. There are regimes for reporting and reacting.

Some facts about kindergartens in Norway:

- ☒ Kindergartens in Norway provide pedagogical early childhood education and care for children aged (0)1-5. School starting age is 6. All kindergartens regardless of ownership (public and private) are publicly funded and regulated by the Kindergarten Act with regulations. A maximum parental fee was introduced in 2004.
- ☒ A right to a kindergarten place for children aged 1-5 entered into force in 2009. It is a statutory right for the child. It is not compulsory.
- ☒ Participation in kindergarten is high: 97.2 per cent of all 3-5-year olds attend kindergarten, 88.6 per cent of all 1-2 year olds. The Framework plan (curriculum framework) is a regulation to the Kindergarten Act and is being applied across all provision (public/private). It sets the frame for the pedagogical practices that shall be applied in all kindergartens (regardless of profile or ownership).

Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is compulsory.]

No

Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is not compulsory.]

Yes

Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is free of charge for all.]

No

Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is not free.]

Yes

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Pre-primary education is not free of charge for all.
20 hours per week is free for children aged 2-5 in low-income-families (see below)

- ☒ Maximum parental fees are regulated and set in the annual national budget. From August 2024 the maximum fee is NOK 2000/month.
- ☒ The second child in kindergarten shall have a 30 per cent reduction in fees. From the 3rd child and more in a family that attends kindergarten at the same time, the place in kindergarten is free of charge.
- ☒ Children aged 2-5 in low-income families have the right to 20 hours/week free ECEC.
- ☒ In addition a national measure is put in place so that no family shall pay more than 6 % of family income for a place in kindergarten.
- ☒ Kindergartens in Norway are publicly funded. Parental fees cover only 9 per cent of running costs (2023).
- ☒ A place in kindergarten is free of charge in targeted areas in North of Norway (Nord-Troms and Finnmark).
In targeted municipalities (small rural communities) the maximum fee is reduced to NOK 1500/month from 2024.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Limited access]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Poor quality programmes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Poor learning outcomes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Low number of professionally trained educators]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Lack of support to families]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Other]

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

- ☒ Norway has high participation rates in kindergartens (ECEC). However, uptake is still lower in some groups of the population – such as children with a minority background or children in low income families. This is why Norway have sought to strengthe policies in these areas by lowering the maximum fee and having targeted reduction schemes, putting measures in place so as to make it easier for families to avail of the free places in kindergarten and the reduction schemes, and to strengthen quality by offering support for more staffing in targeted areas.
- ☒ The Directorate for Education and Training provides guidance and support to develop inclusive practices in ECEC (fulfilling the requirements in the Kindergarten Act and the Framework plan).
- ☒ The expansion of the sector with near universal participation among children aged 1-5, the strenghtening the requirements of the pedagogical framework, the strengthened norm for kindergarten teachers (1:7 children under 3 years of age and 1:14 children over 3 years of age) and introducing the norm for kindergarten staffing (1:3 children under 3 years of age and 1:6 children over 3 years of age) has entailed a lag in terms of reaching the ambitions for increasing the proportion of teachers (i.e.pedagogues) in the teams working with the groups of children. All groups are lead by a kindergarten teacher/pedagogical leader which means that the proportion varies from 33.3 per cent to 60 per cent with a mean of 42.4 per cent, but the aim is for a situation where 50 per cent of staff shall be educated kindergarten teachers (bachelor level ISCED 6).
- ☒ Norway aims for all assistants working in the teams being trained. We aim to have least 25 per cent of staff working directly with children to be trained child-and youth care workers on vocational level (ISCED 3).
- ☒ The National Strategy for Kindergartens towards 2030 (Kindergartens for the New Era 2023-2030) - and the Strategy for raising Competence in Kindergartens (2023-2025) set out aims and direct efforts towards increasing the proportion of kindergarten teachers and trained staff.

2.2 Primary and secondary education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.” Primary education - Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education: Mainstream, basic education in Norway is 7 + 3 + 3 years – primary, lower secondary and upper secondary education and training – of which the first ten years are compulsory. Pupil starts in primary school at the age of 6.
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is compulsory] Yes
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is not compulsory.] No
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is free of charge.] Yes
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is not free.] No
- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added. According to the Education Act section 2-1, children and young people are obliged to attend primary and lower secondary education and have the right to a public primary and lower secondary education. Every person that has completed ten years of compulsory education is entitled by law to three years of upper secondary education and training according to section 5-1. See also chapter 1.1 above. Norway has a comprehensive public education system, covering all levels from Kindergarten to higher education, and including vocational education and training, as well as adult education. Whereas all public education from primary education and upwards is delivered free of entrance and tuition fees, parents have to pay a fee for children in Kindergarten.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Limited access] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [High dropout rates] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor quality programmes] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in foundation literacy] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in numeracy] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in social and emotional learning] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Other poor learning outcomes] Yes
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Disparity in learning outcomes] Yes
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Low number of professionally trained teachers] Yes

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Learning outcomes (see similar text provided for under secondary education)

There has been a negative development in learning outcomes in recent years.

Norwegian pupils have participated in international surveys since the mid-1990s. Surveys such as TIMSS, PISA and PIRLS make it possible to see the development of pupils learning results over time, and to compare between countries.

The development in results from the international surveys in the period 1995–2015 was characterized by a decline followed by an improvement. The positive development was largely linked to an improvement in results for the lowest performing pupils. The progress was also most marked for mathematics and science at the 4th grade. PIRLS 2016 showed that Norwegian 10-year-olds were far above the international average in reading, and that Norwegian pupils had made clear progress since PIRLS 2006.

From 2015, there are signs of decline in several surveys. In PISA 2018, the Norwegian 15-year-olds performed more poorly in science and reading compared to PISA 2015. That year there was also a clear change in the pupils' reading habits compared to PISA 2009. Several pupils said that they spent less time reading in their free time. At the same time, the time they spent reading on the screen increased.

TIMSS 2019 showed consistently good results in mathematics and science at the primary level, but a significant decrease in the results at the lower secondary level. PIRLS 2021 showed for the first time a decline in 10-year-olds' reading skills. The results were still well above the international average. Norwegian 10-year-olds reported the lowest reading enjoyment of all the countries in the survey. PIRLS 2021 also showed a marked increase in the use of digital devices in schools from 2016–2021.

PISA 2022 showed a decline in reading, mathematics and science compared to 2018. The decline was large in mathematics and reading, and somewhat less in science. There was also a significant increase in pupils at the lowest mastery levels. The OECD average decreased in all subject areas, compared to 2018. But the decrease in Norway was greater than in most other OECD countries.

In addition to seeing an average negative development in learning results, PISA 2022 showed a sharp increase in the proportion of pupils at the lowest mastery levels. Overall, 41 per cent of the pupils performed at the lowest mastery levels in at least one or more of the subject areas. These pupils will be poorly prepared for further education and working life. PISA 2022 also showed that the proportion of pupils at the highest levels decreased somewhat in reading, and significantly decreased in mathematics from the previous survey.

A selection of the Norwegian 15-year-olds who took part in PISA 2022 also answered tasks and questions about personal finances (Financial Literacy). This section shows that there are large differences in Norwegian pupils' knowledge of personal finances and financial concepts. The Norwegian pupils score just below the OECD average, and over one in five pupils perform at the lowest levels.

In addition to the surveys that measure reading, science and mathematics, Norwegian pupils also participate in surveys that provide information on the development of knowledge about democracy and citizenship (ICCS). The Norwegian pupils showed good knowledge and skills compared to other countries that participated in the ICCS surveys in 2009 and 2016. ICCS 2022 showed for the first time a decline in pupils' knowledge of democracy. The results on the knowledge test were lower in 2022 than in 2009. Norwegian pupils were still above the international average in the survey but had the largest decline of all participating countries.

There are gender differences in learning outcomes and well-being. Various surveys and statistics show that Norwegian girls have a higher learning outcome than boys in several areas at school. At the end of primary school, girls do better than boys in exams. The girls also get better grades in all subjects except physical education and achieve on average four primary school credits more than the boys. This difference is somewhat smaller than for the pandemic years. At the same time, girls score the highest on several negative developmental traits. Girls have worse well-being at school than boys, have more absence from school, and have more psychological problems.

We are experiencing increasing challenges in the school environment. A negative development in the learning environment also emerges in several of the international surveys. Analyses of the TIMSS results show a negative development in learning focus, school affiliation, safe school environment and bullying from 2015 to 2019 among Norwegian pupils in the 9th grade. The PIRLS survey shows that more 5th graders report bullying in 2021 than in 2016.

The Government believes that more practical, active, and varied learning in schools are the most important measures to reverse the negative development in learning outcomes and well-being. In September 2024, the Government therefore presented a white paper to Parliament in which these topics were dealt with.

Secondary education In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training. - Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:

Pupil starts in lower secondary school at the age of 13.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:
General and vocational upper secondary education have a common Core Curriculum and are often offered at the same schools. Upper secondary education and training covers the years 11 to 13 and normally serves the 16–19 age group. It includes general education and vocational education and training. General study programmes normally last three years and lead to a university admission qualification. Vocational education and training normally last four years, of which the first two years are school-based and the last two are work-based (an apprenticeship).
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is compulsory.]
Yes
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is not compulsory.]
No
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is free of charge.]
Yes
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is not free of charge.]
No
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is compulsory.]
No
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is not compulsory.]
Yes
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is free of charge]
Yes
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is not free of charge.]
No
- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.
Act relating to Primary and Secondary Education (the Education Act) (Link (only available in Norwegian): https://lovdata.no/dokument/NL/lov/2023-06-09-30?q=oppl%C3%A6ringslova) The Purpose Clause in section 1-3 states that the education and training, amongst other purposes, shall “provide insight into cultural diversity and show respect for the individual’s convictions. [...]”, and that “All forms of discrimination shall be combated.” According to section 2-1, children and young people are obliged to attend primary and lower secondary education, and have the right to a public primary and lower secondary education. Every person that has completed ten years of compulsory education is entitled by law to three years of upper secondary education and training according to section 5-1. Primary and Secondary Education is supplied free of charge. The school has according to section 11-1 a duty to ensure that the education and training is adapted to the pupil’s abilities and aptitudes. Section 11-4 –11-6 gives pupils who needs this the right to necessary physical adaptation and technical aids, personal assistance and individually tailored training.
- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education: For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.
Yes

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced: Regulations concerning Organisation, Management and Employee Participation (Link: https://lovdata.no/dokument/SFE/forskrift/2011-12-06-1355) Section 12-2.Right to use children aged 13 for work Children who have reached the age of 13 may perform light work. Light work means any work that, due to the nature of the tasks and the special conditions under which they are to be carried out, does not have any unfortunate effect on the children's health, safety or development, and that does not affect their schooling, participation in vocational guidance or training, or their chance of benefiting from education. Section 12-4.Consent of parents or guardians Before children under the age of 15, or children of school age are put to work, the employer shall ensure that written consent is obtained from their parents or guardians. Section 12-5.Limitations on work to be performed by children and young people Persons under the age of 18 shall not perform work that a. ☐ is beyond their physical or mental capabilities; b. ☐ entails exposure to toxic or carcinogenic agents, agents that cause heritable genetic harm, agents that cause harm to the unborn child or that in other ways cause chronic harm to people; c. ☐ entails exposure to harmful radiation; d. ☐ entails a risk of accidents that it is reasonable to assume that persons under the age of 18 are unable to recognise or avoid due to inadequate awareness of safety or insufficient experience, training or practice.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Limited access] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [High dropout rates] Yes
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Poor quality programmes] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Poor learning outcomes] Yes
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Low readiness of primary graduates] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Low number of professionally trained teachers] No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Other]

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Completion rates

The Government has made it a central priority to work towards increased completion rates in upper secondary education. Recent development show an increase in the amount of pupils that complete upper secondary education within six years. Furthermore, over the past eleven years, the proportion who complete upper secondary education has increased by 10 percentage points.

- 82 percent of pupils who started upper secondary school in 2017 completed within six years, which is up 10 percentage points from the 2006 cohort.
- 91 percent of pupils starting in programs for general studies completed within five years.
- 71 percent of pupils starting a vocational program completed within six years.

Learning outcomes (see similar text provided for under primary education)

There has been a negative development in learning outcomes in recent years.

Norwegian pupils have participated in international surveys since the mid-1990s. Surveys such as TIMSS, PISA and PIRLS make it possible to see the development of pupils learning results over time, and to compare between countries.

The development in results from the international surveys in the period 1995–2015 was characterized by a decline followed by an improvement. The positive development was largely linked to an improvement in results for the lowest performing pupils. The progress was also most marked for mathematics and science at the 4th grade. PIRLS 2016 showed that Norwegian 10-year-olds were far above the international average in reading, and that Norwegian pupils had made clear progress since PIRLS 2006.

From 2015, there are signs of decline in several surveys. In PISA 2018, the Norwegian 15-year-olds performed more poorly in science and reading compared to PISA 2015. That year there was also a clear change in the pupils' reading habits compared to PISA 2009. Several pupils said that they spent less time reading in their free time. At the same time, the time they spent reading on the screen increased.

TIMSS 2019 showed consistently good results in mathematics and science at the primary level, but a significant decrease in the results at the lower secondary level. PIRLS 2021 showed for the first time a decline in 10-year-olds' reading skills. The results were still well above the international average. Norwegian 10-year-olds reported the lowest reading enjoyment of all the countries in the survey. PIRLS 2021 also showed a marked increase in the use of digital devices in schools from 2016–2021.

PISA 2022 showed a decline in reading, mathematics and science compared to 2018. The decline was large in mathematics and reading, and somewhat less in science. There was also a significant increase in pupils at the lowest mastery levels. The OECD average decreased in all subject areas, compared to 2018. But the decrease in Norway was greater than in most other OECD countries.

In addition to seeing an average negative development in learning results, PISA 2022 showed a sharp increase in the proportion of pupils at the lowest mastery levels. Overall, 41 per cent of the pupils performed at the lowest mastery levels in at least one or more of the subject areas. These pupils will be poorly prepared for further education and working life. PISA 2022 also showed that the proportion of pupils at the highest levels decreased somewhat in reading, and significantly decreased in mathematics from the previous survey.

A selection of the Norwegian 15-year-olds who took part in PISA 2022 also answered tasks and questions about personal finances (Financial Literacy). This section shows that there are large differences in Norwegian pupils' knowledge of personal finances and financial concepts. The Norwegian pupils score just below the OECD average, and over one in five pupils perform at the lowest levels.

In addition to the surveys that measure reading, science and mathematics, Norwegian pupils also participate in surveys that provide information on the development of knowledge about democracy and citizenship (ICCS). The Norwegian pupils showed good knowledge and skills compared to other countries that participated in the ICCS surveys in 2009 and 2016. ICCS 2022 showed for the first time a decline in pupils' knowledge of democracy. The results on the knowledge test were lower in 2022 than in 2009. Norwegian pupils were still above the international average in the survey but had the largest decline of all participating countries.

There are gender differences in learning outcomes and well-being. Various surveys and statistics show that Norwegian girls have a higher learning outcome than boys in several areas at school. At the end of primary school, girls do better than boys in exams. The girls also get better grades in all subjects except physical education and achieve on average four primary school credits more than the boys. This difference is somewhat smaller than for the pandemic years. At the same time, girls score the highest on several negative developmental traits. Girls have worse well-being at school than boys, have more absence from school, and have more psychological problems.

We are experiencing increasing challenges in the school environment. A negative development in the learning environment also emerges in several of the international surveys. Analyses of the TIMSS results show a negative development in learning focus, school affiliation, safe school environment and bullying from 2015 to 2019 among Norwegian pupils in the 9th grade. The PIRLS

survey shows that more 5th graders report bullying in 2021 than in 2016.

The Government believes that more practical, active, and varied learning in schools are the most important measures to reverse the negative development in learning outcomes and well-being. In September 2024, the Government therefore presented a white paper to Parliament in which these topics were dealt with.

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is free of charge]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures]

No

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Other]

Universal design of main functions, see answer in 1.1.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Features of higher education in Norway

In the course of a few decades, higher education has gone from being reserved for the few to becoming available to a higher proportion of the population. It is a goal that everyone should be able to study regardless of social and geographical background and that the student population reflects the population as a whole as much as possible. Since the turn of the millennium, there has been significant growth in the Norwegian student population, from 186,000 in 2000 to 299,000 students in 2023. A distinctive feature of Norwegian higher education is the wide spread in age from the youngest to the oldest students. This contributes to a diverse student population. Social background is still important for whom takes part in higher education. Young people with highly educated parents take part in higher education to a greater extent than young people who do not have parents with a higher education. Especially on studies that require a high grade point average for entry, a larger proportion of students have parents with higher education. In addition, Norwegian-born with immigrant parents have a markedly higher propensity to study than both immigrants and the rest of the population. Moreover, higher education is characterized by the underrepresentation of men. Numbers show that two out of five students are male and that the distribution has been fairly stable over the past 20 years.

Admission to higher education

Some study programmes require specific subjects from upper secondary education and/or practice, and there are several ways to enter higher education. Acceptance to higher education requires a Diploma from upper secondary school with general admission requirements. This is also awarded to non-vocational students or vocational students who choose to not take their apprenticeship, or who choose to study the required competency courses in upper secondary school. Conversely, study competence can be achieved by the so-called 23/5 rule where applicants must be 23 years of age and have a total of five years of education and/or work experience, as well as passed courses in Norwegian, English, mathematics, science and social studies. To be qualified for certain study programmes (for instance engineering or medical school), the applicant must cover advanced courses in science, such as mathematics, physics and chemistry. Admittance to bachelor level programs is coordinated through the Norwegian Universities and Colleges Admission Service based on grade point average from upper secondary education, with the highest-ranking students offered a place. Additional points are awarded students with science or language specialization from upper secondary education. The number of points awarded also depends on the students age, and whether the student have completed one year of higher education, military service, folk high school or vocational training. Secondary school grades can later be improved via the arrangement of re-sit exams, but half of the study places are only offered based on original transcripts without age or study points. A student at a university or a university college can get scholarships and/or loans from The State Educational Loan Fund. A student welfare organization shall, in cooperation with education institutions, offer student welfare, such as student housing. Several government initiated processes have taken place since 2021 in terms of assessing and reviewing the admission system for higher education. In 2021, the Government appointed a public committee to examine the regulations for admission to higher education. The committee presented an Official Norwegian Report (green paper) in December 2022. Following up the report, the Government presented a White Paper in 2024 to the Parliament with proposed changes to the admission system. The proposed changes are aimed at ensuring that students commence their studies at a younger age than today, enable participation in the labour market at an earlier stage and ensure adequate recruitment to important professions. Some of the proposed changes include lowering the amount of additional points an applicant can attain, replacing gender points with gender quotas and discontinuing specific subject requirements for bachelor degrees in nursing. Furthermore, the changes should simplify current regulations. The Parliament reviewed the White Paper in the Spring of 2024 and adopted a resolution in support of the proposed changes. The changes may be implemented at different stages and most changes will at the earliest stage enter into force from 2027, to ensure predictability for future applicants, Legislative changes are required before the changes can enter into force.

Tuition fees for degree students from outside of the EU and EFTA

Higher education is free of charge for Norwegian citizens and citizens of the EEA. Until 2023, public higher education institutions in Norway have not charged tuition fees for ordinary study programs. In 2023, the Government proposed that from the fall semester of 2023, universities and colleges should charge at least cost-covering tuition fees from new degree students from outside the EU and EFTA. The proposal for tuition fees was passed by the Parliament and from the fall semester of 2023, degree students from countries outside of the EU and EFTA are required a tuition fee. The necessary legislative changes were adopted by the Storting in June 2023. Several exemptions to the requirement apply, such as for exchange students, joint-degree students, PhD students, refugees and foreign citizens with equal rights as Norwegian citizens. In 2024, the Government decided to establish a scholarship program for foreign degree students from chosen partner countries in the Global South, entitled NORSTIP. The program will provide scholarships for approximately 200 students, covering costs related to both tuition fee and living costs. The first scholarships were provided for the fall semester of 2024, and the program is administered by the Directorate for Higher Education and Training (HK-dir). Link to information about NORSTIP (only available in Norwegian): <https://hkdir.no/aktuelt/ny-stipendordning-for-studenter-fra-utvalgte-partnerland-norstip>

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Limited access]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Poor quality programmes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Poor learning outcomes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Low number of professionally trained professors]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
See further elaboration above.
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education]
Yes
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of literacy programmes]
Yes
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)]
No
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of free of charge learning opportunities]
Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.]

No

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Other]

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:
Adults have a statutory right to primary and secondary education and training, free of charge, delivered by the municipalities and counties, respectively. They also have right to career guidance and counselling and validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning.
The social partners cooperate closely with the government to ensure that relevant Life-Long Learning (LLL) opportunities are available.
All adults have the right to get their knowledge and skills acquired through work experience, non-formal and informal learning, evaluated and validated. The validation process often leads to a partial or complete certificate of upper secondary education and training.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Limited access]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Poor quality programmes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Limited funding]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Poor learning outcomes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Low number of professionally trained educators]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
From 2024, modular training will be used as the main model for education for adults, both in primary and secondary education. By splitting the education into modules, the students may more easily combine primary and secondary education, and secondary vocational training, with work or other activities. Modules also increases the possibilities of being able to start and complete primary and secondary education for adults.

3. Quality education provision and learning environment

3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [State monitoring and inspections]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Health and sanitation]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Infrastructure]
No

3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Curriculum]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Student-teacher ratio]
No
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [School fees (if relevant)]
No
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Other]
- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:
The municipalities and county authorities are responsible for ensuring that students' rights are safeguarded and that school buildings comply with laws and regulations. Each school has a head-teacher as well as various boards and committees. The Norwegian Directorate for Education and Training is the executive agency of the Ministry of Education and Research. "Boosting competencies in special education and inclusive practice" is a programme to help ensure the municipal and county authorities have the competencies they need, enabling them to identify and follow up all children and pupils so that they get a well-adapted and inclusive educational offering in kindergarten and school. The programme started in 2020 and is still under development, until it becomes a permanent solution from 2025.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Violence in schools]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Cost of education]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Conflicts or crises]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Inadequate parental support to education]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Long distances to schools]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
Please see text provided in part 2. of this reporting, for relevant information.
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to "substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers". - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Teacher training is provided without discrimination.]
Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Teachers’ average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Establishment of performance monitoring systems.]

No

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.]

No

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Other]

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

There are eleven kinds of teacher education in Norway. The kinds differ chiefly in which parts of the school system they qualify students for work in. There are different educations for the pre-school, primary and secondary school levels, as well as distinct educations for vocational teachers, teachers in practical and aesthetic subjects and for teaching in the Sami languages.

The teacher educations have regulatory frameworks that specify their purpose and set constraints on their content and structure. The regulatory frameworks state that the teacher educations shall prepare students for developing the school as an institution for learning and character formation in a democratic and diverse society. Every teacher education, moreover, shall enable students to sustain knowledge and understanding of the conditions of Sami people, including the international status of Indigenous peoples and the educational rights of Sami pupils. The regulatory frameworks also direct the educations to build upon the specific laws that cover pre-school, primary and secondary school education. The purpose clauses of the respective laws state that all forms of discrimination are to be counteracted.

The Norwegian Government presented a white paper (Meld. St. 19 (2023-2024)) concerning the professions educations in 2024. The white paper presents measures for educating more teachers and for promoting equality and diversity in the educational programs. Following this white paper, the Government has also made changes to the rules of admission for teacher educations, to make the educations accessible to larger groups of applicants. The regulatory changes contribute to a concerted effort to improve teacher recruitment. To this end, there is also a national recruitment project and a recruitment strategy that was developed in close cooperation with employer organizations and professions organizations/unions. There is also an ongoing work with making the governance of teacher educations less detailed, so that the educational institutions attain greater freedom and flexibility in carrying out and developing their educational programs.

Link to white paper on the professions educations (only available in Norwegian):
<https://www.regjeringen.no/no/dokumenter/meld.-st.-19-20232024/id3032273/>

Link to strategy on recruitment to the teachers professions for the period of 2024-2030 (only available in Norwegian):
<https://www.regjeringen.no/no/dokumenter/strategi-for-larerrekruttering/id3025152/>

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Shortages of teaching staff]

No

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Lack of training centres]

No

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]

No

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [High student – teacher ratio]

No

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

In the last few years, there has been falling enrollment to teacher educations. Some of the educations also experience gender imbalances, most clearly in the case of educations directed for work in pre-school and lower-level primary school, in which there are large female majorities. As noted above, there are several measures being carried out to improve recruitment. There are also efforts to make the composition of teacher students (and hence future teachers) mirror the composition of the population at large.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Curriculum includes human rights education.]

Yes

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.]

Yes

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Other]

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

The curriculum from 2020 has Regulation status and sets parameters for the teaching. The framework plans for teacher education programmes must be based on the Education Act and applicable curricula for primary and secondary education and training. The core curriculum for primary and secondary education states that the education and training given must comply with human rights, and the pupils must also acquire knowledge about these rights.

Democratic Mobilisation against Racism and Anti-Semitism (DEMBRA) is a programme for schools for the prevention of racism, group-based hostility and antidemocratic attitudes. DEMBRA is a programme for professional development amongst teachers, school leaders and other school staff., in primary school, secondary school, upper secondary school and is also a offer to teacher training institutions. DEMBRA is based on the principle of participation and inclusion based on knowledge, critical thinking and diversity competence. DEMBRA supports schools through teacher training and a process of school development. Guided by experts, schools engage in mapping, analysing and responding to local challenges related to group hostility and undemocratic attitudes. DEMBRA builds on the understanding that the role and strategies of schools in the broader societal task of enhancing cohesion and preventing group enmity should be grounded in pedagogy, the mandate of schools and the competence of teachers. Digital resources have been developed for professional development related to teaching about controversial topics in schools. The resources are available at dembra.no. Digital resources on conspiracy theories and acts of conspiracy, will be launched in late autumn 2024. They will be available at dembra.no.

Link to Dembra (only available in Norwegian):
<https://www.dembra.no/no>

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:]

Yes

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:][Comment]

The Act relating to equality and a prohibition against discrimination (Equality and Anti-Discrimination Act) section 6 prohibits discrimination on the basis of gender, pregnancy, leave in connection with childbirth or adoption and care responsibilities. The Act applies to all sectors of society. See the answer provided in chapter 1.1.

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:]

No

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:][Comment]

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:]

No

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:][Comment]

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:]

Yes

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:][Comment]

The Education Act Section 2-1 gives children a right to a public primary and lower secondary education, and an obligation to attend primary and lower secondary education. The obligation can also be met by means of homeschooling or attending a private school. The Private Schools Act regulates private primary and lower secondary schools and private upper secondary schools. The Act has rules concerning the approval of private schools entitled to state subsidies. The Private School Act section 2-1 states that in order for a private school to be approved, it must operate on one of the following bases: a. life philosophy b. recognized educational direction c. international d. specially arranged upper secondary education in combination with elite sports e. Norwegian primary school education abroad f. specially arranged education for pupils with documented needs g. upper secondary education in small craft subjects that are worthy of preservation Norway is obliged by international conventions to ensure that children have the opportunity to choose alternatives to public school. Through the approval scheme, the state will ensure that children and young people who attend a private primary or lower secondary school fulfil the education obligation according to the Education Act. The Norwegian Directorate for Education and Training processes applications for the establishment of private schools, supervises schools meeting the requirements of the regulations and ensures that state subsidies benefits pupils.

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Registration]

No

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [State monitoring and inspections]

No

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Qualifications of teachers]

No

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Health and sanitation]
No
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))]
No
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Infrastructure]
No
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Curriculum]
No
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Student-teacher ratio]
No
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [School fees]
No
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [School closures]
No
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Other]
- Please elaborate:
See information provided in the previous section.
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]
No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Low number of professionally trained teachers]
No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [High student – teacher ratio]
No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Issues in terms of equity and inclusion]
No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity]
No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.]
Yes

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)]

Yes

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.]

No

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content, including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.]

Yes

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.]

Yes

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education]

Yes

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.]

Yes

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.]

No

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

• ☒ In 2023, the Government announced a Strategy for digital competence and infrastructure in kindergarten and school (2023-2030). The strategy was developed in collaboration with The Norwegian Association of Local and Regional Authorities (KS) and contains 80 different measures and actions. The strategy also contains measures for increasing compliance to the regulation of universal access of ICT. The government is in 2024 examining the legal, pedagogical and organisational grounds for a support service for municipalities and suppliers of digital teaching material, with regard to universal design and access.

• ☒ According to the Education Act in Norway, public primary to upper secondary education is free of charge, including learning materials. The Local and Regional Authorities that own the schools provide both analog and digital learning materials to the pupils. As a measure in the new Strategy for digital competence and infrastructure, the government is currently developing a service directory for digital learning materials, in order to help teachers find relevant learning materials. These will primarily be commercially developed products, procured under licensing agreements between the school owners and developers, but the government also provides funding for the development of learning materials where there is no viable commercial market.

• ☒ The national curriculum in Norway defines digital skills as one of five basic skills. These skills are part of the competence in the subjects and necessary tools for learning and understanding them. Programming and algorithmic thinking was introduced in several subjects with the renewal of the curriculum in 2020.

• ☒ In order for pupils to be able to develop basic skills and academic knowledge in a more digital school-day, teachers must have professional digital competence (PDC). There have been many national efforts to increase teachers' digital competence over the last few years, among others further education in professional digital competence through the Competence for Quality strategy and the development of digital competence packages: Digital Skills, Professional Digital Competence, Programming and Algorithmic Thinking, and Digital Teaching at School and at Home.

• ☒ The Norwegian digital learning arena (NDLA) is funded by a collaboration 18 county municipalities, and is by NDLA described as an OER repository developed for Upper Secondary School.

• ☒ For the higher education sector, Sikt is the Norwegian Agency for Shared Services in Education and Research. The organization is a public administrative body under the Ministry of Education and Research. Sikt has developed and managed DLR (Deling av læringsressurser), which is an OER service for several years.

• ☒ In 2024, the Government announced a new national digitalisation strategy for the period 2024-2030. One of the priority areas in the strategy is to preserve trust, strengthen inclusion and ensure that adequate consideration is taken into account concerning children and youth.

Link to strategy (only available in Norwegian):

<https://www.regjeringen.no/contentassets/c499c3b6c93740bd989c43d886f65924/no/pdfs/nasjonal-digitaliseringsstrategi.pdf>

• ☒ Children and youth encounter digitalization and new technology in all arenas. This provides opportunities, but also challenges which require more knowledge on. The Government has therefore constituted a committee which will examine the consequences of children and youths screen use, on their health, learning, well-being and upbringing, and suggest measures. The committee is foreseen to deliver its recommendations within November 1st 2024.

• ☒ In 2024 the Directorate for Education and Training published guidelines with national recommendations on pupils' access to and use of mobile phones and smart watches in school. The use of mobile phones should be strictly regulated in classrooms at both primary, secondary and upper secondary level. The recommendations also state that recess should be mobile-free at both the primary and lower secondary level. The guidelines have been developed to assist the municipalities, county councils and schools in their work at the local level.

Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework. - Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

In Norway the national curriculum is considered part of the legal framework for school education. Pupils' digital skills are considered one of the five basic skills in the curriculum. Along with reading, writing, counting and oral skills, digital skills are a prerequisite for learning and development in school, work, and social life.

In Norway, according to the Equality and Anti-Discrimination Act, all digital learning materials should be universally accessible (WCAG 2.1). This is also regulated in section 10-2 in Act relating to universities and university colleges section 10-2.

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways]

No

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions]

No

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Limited access to internet and/or electricity]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.)]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

4. Strengthening governance systems

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.]
No
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring results are made public]
Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.]
Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.]
No
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.]
Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.]
Yes

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.]
No
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.]
Yes
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
As for the financing of the county and municipal government, the Norwegian Parliament has adopted a decentralised administrative structure, which delegates considerable authority and financial freedom of action to the county level. Block grants are given, and county and municipal authorities determine their activities according to existing legislation and regulations. The Ministry of Education and Research emphasises the importance of placing local responsibility for didactical interpretation and adaptation with the school owner, in accordance with the Education Act and national regulations. All state institutions are expected to use a system of planning that covers both the short term (the budget year) and the medium term (3–4 years or more). State institutions must also formulate their objectives through a dialogue with the responsible Ministry and establish a system for following up their results. The administration and management of schools and institutions vary according to their level in the education system. The municipality/county administration influences the extent of self-governance in schools/institutions in the municipality/county. In higher education, all institutions are administered by the Ministry of Education and Research and follow the provisions laid down in Act of 1 August 2024 on Universities and University Colleges, as well as the general laws, agreements and provisions applicable to all state institutions. The Ministry is also responsible for monitoring private higher education.
Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:
Statistics concerning all levels of education is made available by Statistics Norway: https://www.ssb.no/en/utdanning Statistics is made available by the Directorate for Education and Training: https://www.udir.no/in-english/ Education data and statistics can also be found accessible in English through the yearly OECD Education at a Glance publication: https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/education-at-a-glance-2024-country-notes_fab77ef0-en/norway_39130783-en.html
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Budgetary constraints]
No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels]
No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions]
No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment]
No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data]
No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages]

No

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources]

Yes

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments]

Yes

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Other]